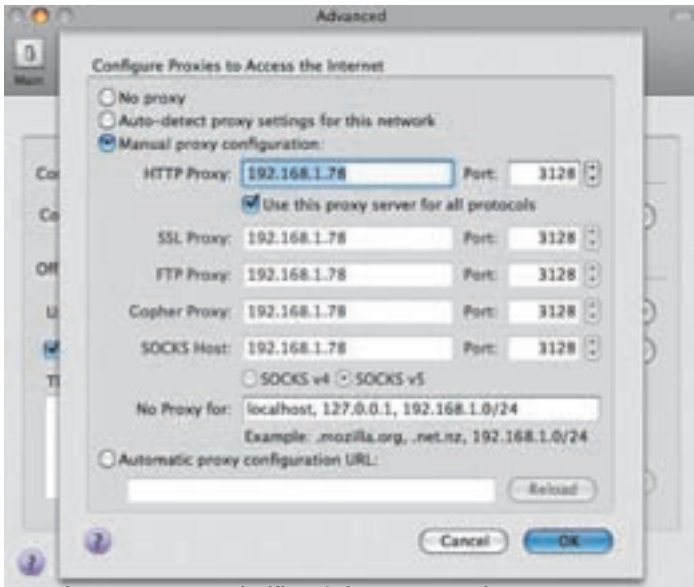




Using a proxy server significantly increases security

speeding up access to a resource via caching. The two main proxies we'll talk about are web proxies and content filtering proxies.

Web proxies are those focusing on www traffic. The most common use for a web proxy is in web caching. Caching keeps local copies of frequently requested resources allowing one to significantly reduce their upstream bandwidth cost and usage while increasing performance. Some web proxies also provide a means to deny access to certain URLs in a blacklist, thus providing for some form of content filtering.

One of the more well-known freeware web proxies is Squid. It functions as a proxy server and a web cache daemon. It serves a variety of uses from speeding up a web server to caching repeated requests. It also caches web, DNS, and other computer network lookups for people sharing network resources. Squid also aids in filtering traffic thus aiding in security. It also has some features that can help anonymize connections such as disabling or changing specific header fields in a client's HTTP